

Global I/O

Tech Hardware & Semis

3Q26 UBS APAC Tech Tour: AI strength unaltered, Semiscap noticeably bullish

AI, CPU strength continues; lowering 2027 smartphone and PC forecasts

We met 40 companies during the UBS 3Q26 APAC Tech Tour in China, HK, Taiwan, Korea and Japan, whilst the 2026 Taiwan Summit also took place. In spite of recent calls for the need for an AI slowdown, key upstream enablers (foundry, memory) have seen no changes, and expect strength for the coming years. In the near term, we increase our '26E Nvidia rack forecast to 80k (+2.5k) and maintain '27E at 95k. CPU demand keeps seeing upside, with initial indications for Vera strong. On the other hand, we lower our 3Q26E notebook ODM shipments with now a 17% QoQ decline. Memory supply will weigh on PC units in '27, and we lower our forecast for PC Sell In to -4% YoY in '27E (was +2%) after -11% in '26E ([link](#)). Likewise, we now forecast -3% YoY for smartphone unit Sell In in '27E (was +2%) after -10% in '26E ([link](#)). The iPhone supply chain continues to see resilience though relative to Android.

AI semis well on track, raising CoWoS estimates

In components, AI server MLCC demand could double this year and in '27. IC substrates pricing could be up 20% QoQ in 3Q26, high single digit to low teens % in 4Q. AI ASICs and SOCAMM PCB demand is upsizing. AI/HPC demand visibility for TSMC extends to '29-'30. Trailing edge foundry and OSAT utilisation rates are trending upwards. TPU V8t is on track to contribute >US\$2bn in '26 revs to Mediatek, and US\$12-16bn in '27, with a solid position into V9 and beyond. Aspeed could grow revs 60% QoQ in 4Q26. China AI accelerators demand and localisation is progressing at a fast pace with HBM a bottleneck to watch. Advanced packaging remains in focus, and we forecast CoWoS capacity to reach 270k wpm end of '27E from 160k wpm end of '26E.

Further server DDR5/SSD demand upside, semiscap bullish outlook stands out

Hyperscalers keep upsizing demand requests for '27 for both server DDR5 and enterprise SSDs. Mobile DRAM pricing is re-basing up in 3Q26, and we increase our DRAM ASP assumptions for Samsung and SK Hynix. HBM de-specing for Rubin Ultra has not negatively impacted demand. Wafer Fab Equipment vendors were particularly bullish, noting a step up in orders mid-year and extended visibility. Samsung and SK Hynix may move to a cadence of filling up one memory clean room every 6 months in (P5-1, Y1). We raise our capex forecasts for both. Advanced logic orders (TSMC, Intel) have strengthened. China WFE demand is well supported by both Memory and Logic. Testers' demand look particularly supported by AI ASIC and CPU demand/testing cycles. Hybrid bonding adoption for HBM may be pushed out.

Top sector picks remain Memory, Semiscap and MLCCs

We add to our APAC Tech Most Preferred list Delta Electronics (Key Call Buy), DI, KYEC, and remove GUC, Hansol Chem and Wiwynn (all Buy-rated). Our **Most Preferred** list includes: Accton, Advantest, AEM, All Ring, ASE, Delta, DI, Eugene Tech, Hon Hai, ISU, JCET, KYEC, MediaTek, Murata, Naura, Samsung, SEMCO, Simmtech, SK Hynix, Tokyo Electron, TSMC. We remove from Least Preferred Hua Hong and add Realtek (both Neutral). Our **Least Preferred** list includes: Asustek, Compal, Desay, Hanmi, Innolux, Largan, LG Display, LG Electronics, Maxscend, Pegatron, Realtek, Xiaomi.

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Figure 1: UBS APAC Tech Most/Least Preferred lists

Company	Ticker	Analyst	Rating	Price	PT	'27E P/E	'28E P/E	'27E P/BV	'28E P/BV
Most preferred									
Accton	2345.TW	Jerry Su	Buy	NT\$1840	NT\$3688	15.3	10.9	8.03	5.75
Advantest	JP6857	Atsuhiko Kinoshita	Buy	¥32050	¥43600	33.5	27.1	16.22	11.34
AEM Holdings	AEM.SI	Joseph Koh	Buy	S\$9.95	S\$16	22.4	17.0	4.53	3.71
All Ring	6187.TWO	Sunny Lin	Buy	NT\$1235	NT\$1700	26.2	16.0	10.21	7.47
ASE	3711.TW	Sunny Lin	Buy	NT\$663	NT\$835	21.4	17.1	5.60	4.84
Delta Electronics	2308.TW	Randy Abrams	Buy	NT\$1875	NT\$2750	27.8	20.8	9.73	7.35
D.I Corp	003160.KS	Jimmy Yoon	Buy	Won35400	Won50000	12.3	9.3	3.71	3.06
Eugene Technology	084370.KQ	Nicolas Gaudois	Buy	Won140400	Won182000	21.5	16.3	4.41	3.52
Hon Hai Precision	2317.TW	Randy Abrams	Buy	NT\$250	NT\$340	10.7	9.1	1.66	1.50
ISU Petasys	007660.KS	Jimmy Yoon	Buy	Won110300	Won190000	18.2	14.5	5.64	4.18
JCET Group	600584.SS	Jimmy Yu	Buy	Rmb72.22	Rmb135	31.5	22.9	3.72	3.27
King Yuan	2449.TW	Sunny Lin	Buy	NT\$301.5	NT\$325	20.4	16.4	5.07	4.42
MediaTek	2454.TW	Sunny Lin	Buy	NT\$5010	NT\$6500	27.6	16.6	13.78	10.47
Murata Mfg.	JP6981	Shingo Hirata	Buy	¥7763	¥13200	23.9	17.7	4.51	3.92
NAURA Technology	002371.SZ	Jimmy Yu	Buy	Rmb676.61	Rmb905	42.4	28.4	8.95	6.94
Samsung Electronics	005930.KS	Nicolas Gaudois	Buy	Won274000	Won535000	3.7	3.2	1.58	1.20
SEMCO	009150.KS	Jimmy Yoon	Buy	Won1429000	Won2700000	25.5	16.1	7.05	5.00
Simmtech	222800.KQ	Jimmy Yoon	Buy	Won130700	Won195000	13.4	10.5	4.25	3.03
SK Hynix	000660.KS	Nicolas Gaudois	Buy	Won1868000	Won3000000	3.1	2.5	2.28	1.62
Tokyo Electron	JP8035	Atsuhiko Kinoshita	Buy	¥53110	¥93600	22.5	18.6	9.22	8.09
TSMC	2330.TW	Sunny Lin	Buy	NT\$2480	NT\$3650	16.6	12.5	6.13	4.48
Least preferred									
Asustek	2357.TW	Randy Abrams	Neutral	NT\$946	NT\$910	13.5	13.2	2.30	2.18
Compal	2324.TW	Randy Abrams	Neutral	NT\$37.6	NT\$40	13.3	10.7	1.18	1.12
Desay Battery	000049.SZ	Edward Liu	Sell	Rmb22.43	Rmb21	16.4	12.5	1.16	1.08
Hanmi Semiconductor	042700.KS	Jimmy Yoon	Sell	Won236500	Won170000	44.5	37.3	18.88	14.83
INNOLUX Corporation	3481.TW	Jerry Su	Sell	NT\$50.4	NT\$26	83.5	71.8	1.74	1.76
Largan	3008.TW	Randy Abrams	Sell	NT\$6400	NT\$5000	29.9	25.5	3.94	3.62
LG Display	034220.KS	Jimmy Yoon	Neutral	Won8520	Won11600	7.3	5.2	0.57	0.53
LG Electronics	066570.KS	Jimmy Yoon	Neutral	Won202500	Won168000	11.6	10.5	1.05	0.95
Maxscend	300782.SZ	Jimmy Yu	Neutral	Rmb76.34	Rmb80.2	NM	152.1	3.52	3.44
Pegatron	4938.TW	Randy Abrams	Neutral	NT\$90.8	NT\$95	12.7	10.6	1.09	1.01
Realtek	2379.TW	Sunny Lin	Neutral	NT\$740	NT\$690	18.3	17.1	7.22	6.57
Xiaomi	1810.HK	Jimmy Yu	Neutral	HK\$27.58	HK\$30.4	20.4	14.1	2.06	1.81

Source: UBS estimates. Priced as of September 21st, 2026.

Figure 2: UBS APAC Tech market/sector weights

	Overweight	Neutral weight	Underweight
Markets	Korea, Taiwan	Japan	China
Sub-sectors	Leading Edge Foundry	Fabless ICs	Displays
	Memory Semis	Silicon wafers	PCs
	MLCCs	Trailing edge foundries	Smartphones
	OSATs		
	Server ODMs		
	Wafer Fab Equipment		

Source: UBS estimates

Tech Hardware

AI Servers

The AI supply chain remains strong. **Our supply chain work points to 52% accelerator unit growth in '27**; combined with higher ASPs from the transition to 3nm and continued memory inflation gives scope for further upward revisions, with '27 capex growth likely to remain in the high double digits.

- **Supply chain seeing strength from new product ramps increasingly gated by component bottlenecks.** Companies across the supply chain expect strong revenue ramps in the coming quarters to support upcoming ramps in AI with NVIDIA's VR200, AMD MI450/455 Helios, TPU v8i/t, OpenAI's Jalapeno, and CPUs from AMD (Venice) and Intel (Clearwater Forest). With demand exceeding available supply across the hyperscalers, neoclouds and AI natives, the supply chain is seeing strong order visibility for the coming quarters. Bottlenecks have continued in memory, advanced foundry, high-end PCB/substrates, MLCCs and increasingly in AI power ICs with extending lead times pushing some deliveries

from Delta and Accton into Q426.

- Raising '26E NVIDIA rack forecast from 77.5k to 80k, maintain '27E at 95k.** NVIDIA's Blackwell Ultra GB300 NVL72 racks remain the mainstream for most of this year and continue strong through Q326, tracking a bit stronger across Hon Hai, Quanta and Wistron with all 3 companies having revenue upside driven by AI servers this quarter. The HGX channel is also healthy from a wider set of ODMs including Lenovo, Asus, Pegatron, Compal, and Gigabyte as buyers broaden to more neoclouds, regional data centers and enterprises. For '27E, we maintain our forecast for 95k racks and could have 20-30k further upside subject to data center readiness and higher hyperscale/neo cloud capex budgets. Our base case of 95k racks still drives strong sales growth with ODMs confirming 70% higher ASPs to US\$7-8mn for Rubin racks relative to Blackwell to supplement the ~20% rack unit growth. The high ASPs and unit growth look to support NVIDIA's view to potentially double sales in '27.
- Rubin and Helios downstream racks underpin 2027 growth.** Our feedback suggests Rubin Racks are undergoing regular firmware updates and final testing on liquid cooling to ramp up in more volume from November, though only to about 5k of our 80k '26E NVL72 forecast. The large CSPs should see a steep ramp on Rubin although some of the smaller buyers should stay on Blackwell into H127. For AMD's Helios, compute boards are starting shipments in Q426 although ODMs believe Q227 will be the quarter for a higher volume inflection as they continue to improve testing and system integration.

Figure 3: Raising '26E NVIDIA racks from 77.5k to 80k, maintaining '27E at 95k

GB200/GB300 Rack Units	2025	Q126E	Q226E	Q326E	Q426E	2026E	Q127E	Q227E	Q327E	Q427E	2027E
Quanta	6,420	4,000	5,200	5,800	5,100	20,100	2,700	1,200	705	700	5,305
Hon Hai	10,550	5,400	6,200	7,620	7,300	26,520	3,500	2,500	1,000	500	7,500
Wistron	5,860	3,905	4,250	5,100	3,900	17,155	2,700	1,400	900	500	5,500
Total (Top 3)	22,830	13,305	15,650	18,520	16,300	63,775	8,900	5,100	2,605	1,700	18,305
SMCI, Wiwynn, GigaByte, Inventec, Asus, Lenovo, Pega, etc	4,204	2,861	3,130	3,704	3,260	12,955	1,335	765	261	170	2,531
Others share %	18%	22%	20%	20%	20%	20%	15%	15%	10%	10%	14%
GB200 racks (market-wide)	20,690	7,275	5,634	4,445	1,956	19,309	1,024	293	143	0	1,460
mix %	77%	45%	30%	20%	10%	25%	10%	5%	5%	0%	7%
GB300 racks (market-wide)	6,344	8,891	13,146	17,779	17,604	57,420	9,212	5,572	2,722	1,870	19,375
mix %	23%	55%	70%	80%	90%	75%	90%	95%	95%	100%	93%
Total GB200/300 racks (market-wide)	27,034	16,166	18,780	22,224	19,560	76,730	10,235	5,865	2,866	1,870	20,836
Total GB200/300 GPUs into racks	1,946,412	1,163,921	1,352,160	1,600,128	1,408,320	5,524,529	736,920	422,280	206,316	134,640	1,500,156

VR200 NVL72 Rack Units	2025	Q126E	Q226E	Q326E	Q426E	2026E	Q127E	Q227E	Q327E	Q427E	2027E
Quanta					1,300	1,300	4,000	6,400	5,100	4,300	19,800
Hon Hai					1,700	1,700	6,500	7,000	6,700	6,500	26,700
Wistron				0	200	200	2,600	4,400	3,900	3,500	14,400
Total (Top 3)				0	3,200	3,200	13,100	17,800	15,700	14,300	60,900
SMCI, Wiwynn, GigaByte, Inventec, Asus, Lenovo, Pega, etc				0	160	160	2,227	3,560	3,140	2,860	11,787
Others share %				2%	5%	5%	17%	20%	20%	20%	19%
Total VR200 racks (market-wide)				0	3,360	3,360	15,327	21,360	18,840	17,160	72,687
Total VR200 GPUs into racks				0	241,920	241,920	1,103,544	1,537,920	1,356,480	1,235,520	5,233,464

VR300 Rack Units	2025	Q126E	Q226E	Q326E	Q426E	2026E	Q127E	Q227E	Q327E	Q427E	2027E
Quanta										475	475
Hon Hai										900	900
Wistron										200	200
Total (Top 3)										1,575	1,575
SMCI, Wiwynn, GigaByte, Inventec, Asus, Lenovo, Pega, etc										0	0
Others share %										0%	0%
Total VR300 (market-wide)										1,575	1,575
Total VR300 GPUs into racks										113,400	113,400

Total NVIDIA Racks	2025	Q126E	Q226E	Q326E	Q426E	2026E	Q127E	Q227E	Q327E	Q427E	2027E
GB200/GB300	27,034	16,166	18,780	22,224	19,560	76,730	10,235	5,865	2,866	1,870	20,836
VR200	0	0	0	0	3,360	3,360	15,327	21,360	18,840	17,160	72,687
VR300	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1,575	1,575
Total Racks	27,034	16,166	18,780	22,224	22,920	80,090	25,562	27,225	21,706	20,605	95,098
Total GPUs into Racks	1,946,412	1,163,921	1,352,160	1,600,128	1,650,240	5,766,449	1,840,464	1,960,200	1,562,796	1,483,560	6,847,020

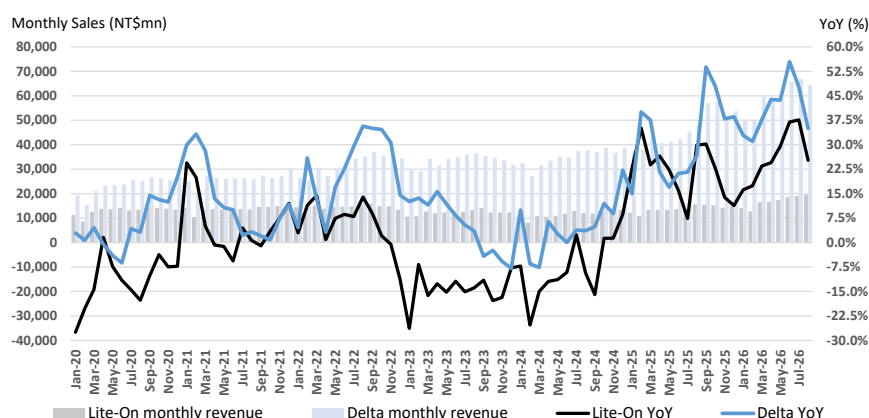
Source: Company data, UBS estimates

- Initial LPU and CPU rack shipments beginning.** The supply chain is engaging on Groq's LPU (language processing unit) rack and Vera CPU racks, with Hon Hai leading production for the LPU and Wistron for the Vera CPU rack. We believe volume for each is ramping up in Q426 to about 1k units per month.
- ODMs prioritize profit dollars despite modest gross-margin pressure.** ODMs continue to focus on increasing value add from generation to generation supporting their customers with US assembly, automated assembly lines and integration of power and cooling. Hon Hai indicated potential to grow its value add +40% from Blackwell to Rubin, which although lagging the 70% rack price increase would still drive a strong YoY profit growth even if shipments were only flat. The ODMs are also negotiating a modest portion of their racks shifting from buy and sell model over to consignment model to help mitigate some of the low

margin pass-through of components to limit GM dilution. For ODMs, the consigned racks can cushion the margin % and improve the balance sheet although likely forfeit some profit dollars from the handling and financing costs.

- **AI power growth remains supply constrained.** Power electronics suppliers Delta and Lite-On both reaffirmed 70%+ growth in their server power business this year and expectation for strong momentum into new AI GPU and ASIC platform launches in coming quarters. Supply is gating demand more meaningfully for Delta which is constrained by stretching lead times on power ICs and capacitors keeping its Q3 sales up 10-12% QoQ vs. original mid-teens expectation. The company has more supply coming in to grow double digits in Q426 and well above its seasonal ~10% decline in Q127 (UBS +3% QoQ) but still sees the supply-demand gap widening near-term before catching up given the order strength. Peer Lite-On with smaller scale and better secured LTAs and early planning for its 2026 ramps indicated it is not materially constrained to meet its customer ramps

Figure 4: Delta still outpacing Lite-On but more gated by supply constraints with its higher revenue scale



Source: company data

- **400/800VDC migration looks inevitable; ASICs lead, GPU timing remains the swing factor.** The Summit feedback reaffirms our APAC Focus on AI Power ([link](#)) for +9% content per watt CAGR on top of strong growth for GW deployed in the coming 1-2 years. Delta and Lite-On both expect IT systems to transition to dedicated power sidecars to deliver power to the server hardware in upcoming generations. Vendors are seeing a first step with Amazon's upcoming launch still with a 250kW 50V power rack for its liquid cooled server followed by multiple hyperscalers deploying from late '27-'28. We expect Google's TPU racks and Amazon's trainum rack to require a power rack as both are seeing the chip design upgrading from 2-die to 4-die systems potentially more than doubling the TDP of the rack and requiring move out of the power supplies. Vendors note Rubin at 227kW TDP already approaching the limits of in-rack power with designs supporting 4 110kW power shelves with hyperscalers often maintaining 1.5x-2x power redundancy, and modest power upgrade for Rubin Ultra could raise 800V penetration if not then by the Feynman generation in H228 where NVIDIA also may move to a 4 die GPU design.

Figure 5: The AI power industry presents a TAM of US\$91bn by '30E and a 69% CAGR from '25-'30E

AI Power TAM build-up	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E	CAGR (25-30)
AI server rack units	237,600	208,418	296,616	428,299	396,708	342,359	369,452	12%
TDP per rack (kW)	40.0	55.4	89.3	118.5	170.7	256.9	282.8	39%
AI IT capacity deployed (GW)	9.5	11.5	26.5	50.8	67.7	87.9	104.5	55%
Power content / IT Watt	\$0.52	\$0.57	\$0.67	\$0.75	\$0.81	\$0.86	\$0.87	9%
AI Power TAM (US\$mn)	\$4,951	\$6,582	\$17,726	\$38,199	\$55,144	\$75,798	\$91,115	69%
YoY TAM Growth		33%	169%	115%	44%	37%	20%	

Source: Company data, UBS estimates

- **Custom ASIC momentum broadening, led by Google and Amazon.** ASIC servers are seeing an accelerating and broadening ramp with total GPU and ASIC

accelerator units projected to grow +32%/+40% YoY in '26E/'27E to 17.5mn/24.9mn units and total die count even higher at 28.3mn/46.6mn, +44%/+65% YoY. We now forecast Google ramping 3.5mn units at Broadcom and 4mn units at MediaTek in '27E for TPU v8 and then upgrading to a 4 die structure for MediaTek's v9 and a stitched together 4 die version for Broadcom in 2028. For Amazon, Trainium 3 is ramping through H226 from 1.8mn units this year (2.4mn total units) to 2.8mn units in 2028 (3.3mn total units). Alchip is working on the four-die design for Trainium 4 for ramp from late '27 into '28. For other ASICs, suppliers see OpenAI Jalapeno starting procurement of substrates and CCL in Q426 and see next Meta ramp H227 loaded. Microsoft's MTIA 200 is also seeing some upside from a low base and longer life through next year supported by GUC before transitioning at the end of next year to MTIA 300 designed by Marvell.

Figure 6: UBS forecasts for racks for AI GPUs and ASICs

AI GPU and ASIC Rack Forecast (UBSe)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E	CAGR '25-30
NVIDIA NVL72+	18	27,034	77,506	95,098	82,000	34,429	27,000	0%
NVIDIA Other (HGX/LPU/CPU)	130,744	63,000	66,303	72,941	83,188	100,016	111,868	12%
AMD	6,164	6,466	8,450	13,765	11,338	9,000	9,168	7%
Total AI GPU Racks	136,926	96,500	152,260	181,803	176,526	143,444	148,035	9%
AWS	39,583	43,935	63,026	82,083	54,952	42,361	44,792	0%
Google	34,820	39,672	59,155	133,465	122,266	100,156	105,113	22%
Meta	5,631	6,448	3,465	5,439	7,448	9,340	10,903	11%
Microsoft	474	553	611	832	965	1,192	1,440	21%
Intel	9,804	7,447	4,225	2,869	1,844	859	391	-45%
OpenAI	0	0	1,771	8,299	15,069	22,604	31,458	N/M
Tesla	1,451	1,025	781	718	986	1,415	1,917	13%
Other ASICs	8,910	12,837	11,323	12,791	16,652	20,985	25,403	15%
Total AI ASIC Racks	100,674	111,918	144,357	246,496	220,182	198,914	221,416	15%
Total Racks	237,600	208,418	296,616	428,299	396,708	342,359	369,452	12%
Chipsets per Rack	43	64	60	58	70	75	77	4%
Total # of Chipsets	10,275,150	13,427,167	17,747,390	24,899,319	27,756,755	25,604,640	28,349,936	16%
Dies per Rack	53	94	95	109	201	263	272	24%
Total # of Dies	12,484,020	19,689,393	28,258,709	46,608,128	79,551,903	90,209,143	100,615,547	39%

Source: UBS. *Assume 75% of chips ship into racks in same year, 25% into the following year

Conventional Servers

- Conventional server demand strong, but memory availability constrains builds.** Server ODMs have revised up forecasts through the year, with Hon Hai, Quanta, Wiywynn, Lenovo and Inventec seeing 20-30% unit growth for the year, with hyperscalers outgrowing that level. Traditional servers are seeing upgrades to serve agentic AI with multi-core processors over less efficient older servers. UBS estimates traditional servers maintaining +21%/+15% YoY growth in '26E/'27E to 22.6/26.0mn units (with total servers 23.8/27.7mn), accelerating from the single-digit CAGR earlier in the decade. In the near-term, the strong growth is causing some volatility, with Inventec shipments down in Aug-Sep constrained by memory but seeing strong order books that could lift shipments in Q426 subject to supply. Wiywynn is noting some slowdown in Q426 after customers prepared ahead of memory constraints with pre-buys but expects another pick-up in H127 as new server chipsets from AMD with Venice and Intel with Clearwater Forest. BMC chipset vendor Aspeed is securing more supply and guiding a very strong Q426 in preparation for some of these builds. Beyond AMD, the design service companies are seeing stronger ramp for hyperscaler ASIC servers, with GUC seeing sharper ramp of Google's Axion CPU, while Graviton continues to see strong unit growth from ASIC server and component suppliers.

Figure 7: UBS server shipment forecasts for '20-'27E

UBS Server Model	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E
Total Server shipments (K unit)	13,550.0	13,967.3	14,942.9	14,086.9	16,025.4	19,976.2	23,770.3	27,738.2
YoY growth (%)	7.5%	3.1%	7.0%	-5.7%	13.8%	24.7%	19.0%	16.7%
Out of which conventional servers	13,030	13,337	14,213	13,304	14,435	18,733	22,624	26,037
YoY growth (%)	5.9%	2.4%	6.6%	-6.4%	8.5%	29.8%	20.8%	15.1%
Traditional Enterprise	5,403	5,147	5,028	4,217	4,283	4,112	4,194	4,278
YoY growth (%)	-5.9%	-4.7%	-2.3%	-16.1%	1.6%	-4.0%	2.0%	2.0%
Hyperscalers	8,147	8,822	9,915	9,883	11,102	15,864	19,576	23,460
YoY growth (%)	25.2%	8.3%	12.4%	-0.3%	12.3%	42.9%	23.4%	19.8%
Standard servers	7,355	7,914	8,916	8,841	9,265	14,363	18,164	21,485
YoY growth (%)	23.8%	7.6%	12.7%	-0.8%	4.8%	55.0%	26.5%	18.3%
AI Servers	520	630	730	783	1,591	1,243	1,146	1,701
YoY growth (%)	73.3%	21.2%	15.9%	7.3%	103.1%	-21.8%	-7.8%	48.4%
Database Servers	272	278	270	259	246	258	266	274
YoY growth (%)	2.0%	2.0%	-3.0%	-4.0%	-5.0%	5.0%	3.0%	3.0%

Source: Company data, UBS estimates

PCs

APAC tech tour feedback reinforced our cautious PC view

- Maintaining '26E PC decline; cut '27E unit forecast.** We retain our forecast for an 11% decline in '26E units and cut '27E from 2% growth to a 4% decline as sustained memory inflation pressures affordability and demand. Industry shipment growth deteriorated from +5.5% YoY in Q126, helped by pull-ins, to -2.5% in Q226, while sequential growth of only 1% was sub-seasonal. ODM feedback and recent monthly sales point to further deterioration in Q326 amid additional OEM order cuts, with 3Q26 NB shipments now tracking to decline -17% QoQ, below our original estimate for an -11% QoQ decline. Memory prices are increasingly a headwind with DRAM contract prices up 766% and NAND prices 471% since mid-'25. For H226E, we model units correcting 20% YoY to keep our full year unchanged at -11% YoY to 241mn units. The price increases and allocation of tight components are lifting ASPs by 14% YoY to support '26E industry revenues +1.4% YoY to US\$202bn.
- Memory could be even more of a headwind for PCs in '27.** UBS's latest memory forecasts suggest that the tight memory supply is going to sustain longer due to the continued acceleration of compute demand. We extended our forecast of the DRAM upcycle to continue until Q228 and NAND flash Q427. Memory makers continue to prioritise hyperscalers and AI customers, which reduces memory allocation to PC OEMs. This will limit further builds into '27.
- Lowering '27E PC units.** Due to memory costs likely to persist at high levels and CPU makers also pushing through double digit price increases through the year, we expect a soft PC unit outlook next year also alongside more modest price hikes. We lower '27E PC units from +2% to -4% YoY to 231mn although with ASPs up

6% YoY would drive PC revenue up 2% to US\$205bn, down from prior US\$210 bn forecast.

Figure 8: UBS PC unit forecasts, '16-'27E

(m units)		2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025E	2026E	2027E
Desktop units		108.0	102.3	99.8	100.3	79.8	85.3	76.1	62.4	61.1	68.3	60.5	58.8
	% YoY	-8.7%	-5.3%	-2.4%	0.5%	-20.4%	6.9%	-10.9%	-17.9%	-2.1%	11.8%	-11.4%	-2.7%
Notebook units		171.6	173.2	174.9	178.6	228.3	256.4	208.0	179.9	186.3	202.5	180.6	172.2
	% YoY	-2.7%	0.9%	1.0%	2.1%	27.8%	12.3%	-18.9%	-13.5%	3.6%	8.7%	-10.8%	-4.6%
Chromebook		9.4	12.8	14.9	16.3	32.6	35.3	19.4	16.6	18.3	19.9	17.2	14.7
	% YoY	38.2%	35.7%	16.8%	9.4%	100.0%	8.2%	-45.2%	-14.2%	10.2%	8.8%	-13.4%	-14.6%
Consumer PC units		123.3	111.1	105.9	98.4	117.5	130.2	105.3	88.4	86.9	93.8	82.5	77.3
	% YoY	-10.9%	-9.9%	-4.7%	-7.0%	19.4%	10.7%	-19.1%	-16.1%	-1.7%	7.9%	-12.1%	-6.3%
Commercial PC units		156.2	164.3	168.8	180.5	190.6	211.6	178.8	153.9	160.5	177.0	158.6	153.8
	% YoY	0.1%	5.2%	2.8%	6.9%	5.6%	11.0%	-15.5%	-13.9%	4.3%	10.3%	-10.4%	-3.0%
Total units		279.5	275.4	274.7	278.9	308.2	341.7	284.1	242.3	247.5	270.8	241.0	231.1
	% YoY	-5.1%	-1.5%	-0.3%	1.5%	10.5%	10.9%	-16.9%	-14.7%	2.1%	9.4%	-11.0%	-4.1%

Source: Gartner, UBS estimates

Notebook ODMs noted further slowdown at UBS Taiwan Summit

- **Notebook ODMs are slowing after pull-ins early in the year.** Units decelerated from Q126 still only -1% YoY at 29.2mn to a -8% YoY decline to 30.4mn in Q226. Shipments are tracking weak through Q326, leading us to cut our Q326 shipments from 26.9mn to 25.1mn, now down 17% QoQ / -26% Yoy following the August monthly sales. ODMs including Compal, Inventec and Quanta all noted softer shipments in H226 due to the steep memory inflation with demand tracking even weaker through Q3. For the full year, we lowered annual shipments from 112.7mn to 109.7mn, now down 15% YoY.

Figure 9: Notebook ODM unit forecasts, '25-'27E

	Q126	Q226	Q326							Q426E	Annual Shipments				
('000 Units)	Q126A	Q226A	Jul (A)	Aug (A)	Aug (E) Prior	Sep (E)	Q326E	Q326E Prior	Q3 Comment	Q426E	2024	2025	2026E	2026E Prior	2026 comment
Quanta	10,000	11,500	2,800	2,600	3,300	3,600	9,000	9,500	>20% decline	8,500	45,900	46,500	39,000	40,100	DD decline
Compal	5,900	6,200	1,800	1,400	2,000	2,000	5,200	6,150	Flat QoQ	5,700	32,300	28,000	23,000	24,450	Down 10-15%
Pegatron	1,800	1,750	400	425	650	600	1,425	1,700	SD decline	1,750	8,055	9,070	6,725	7,050	No guidance
Inventec	5,400	5,400	1,600	1,500	1,600	1,700	4,800	4,900	Down HSD	4,400	20,000	21,300	20,000	19,900	HSD decline
Wistron	6,100	5,500	1,600	1,400	1,650	1,650	4,650	4,650	DD Decline	4,750	20,200	24,100	21,000	21,150	2H down 10~15%
Total	29,200	30,350	8,200	7,325	9,200	9,550	25,075	26,900		25,100	126,455	128,970	109,725	112,650	
Global NBs	47,818	48,452					42,809	45,523		41,473	186,349	202,511	180,551	182,013	
% of NBs	61%	63%					59%	59%		61%	68%	64%	61%	62%	
Global PCs	63,645	64,305					57,435	59,617		55,662	247,459	270,823	241,047	241,624	
% of PCs	46%	47%					44%	45%		45%	51%	48%	46%	47%	
QoQ/MoM	Q126A	Q226A	Jul (A)	Aug (A)	Aug (E) Prior	Sep (E)	Q326E	Q326E Prior	Q3 Comment	Q426E	2024	2025	2026E	2026E Prior	2026 comment
Quanta	-8%	15%	-38%	-7%	18%	38%	-22%	-17%	>20% decline	-6%					
Compal	-13%	5%	-25%	-22%	11%	43%	-16%	-1%	Flat QoQ	10%					
Pegatron	-25%	-3%	-38%	6%	63%	41%	-19%	-3%	SD decline	23%					
Inventec	2%	0%	-33%	-6%	0%	13%	-11%	-9%	Down HSD	-8%					
Wistron	-12%	-10%	-20%	-13%	3%	18%	-15%	-15%	DD Decline	2%					
Total	-10%	4%	-31%	-11%	12%	30%	-17%	-11%		0%					
YoY	Q126A	Q226A	Jul (A)	Aug (A)	Aug (E) Prior	Sep (E)	Q326E	Q326E Prior	Q3 Comment	Q426E	2024	2025	2026E	2026E Prior	2026 comment
Quanta	-7%	-5%	-30%	-37%	-20%	-22%	-29%	-25%		-22%	-2.1%	1.3%	-16%	-14%	DD decline
Compal	-16%	-13%	-22%	-39%	-13%	-20%	-27%	-13%		-16%	-4.7%	-13.3%	-18%	-13%	Down 10-15%
Pegatron	-5%	-26%	-47%	-48%	-21%	-27%	-41%	-29%		-27%	1.6%	12.6%	-26%	-22%	No guidance
Inventec	8%	-4%	-6%	-17%	-11%	-11%	-11%	-9%		-17%	7.0%	6.5%	-6%	-7%	HSD decline
Wistron	24%	-7%	-20%	-36%	-25%	-25%	-27%	-27%		-31%	6.3%	19.3%	-13%	-12%	2H down 10~15%
Total	-1%	-8%	-24%	-35%	-18%	-21%	-26%	-21%		-22%	0%	2%	-15%	-13%	

Source: Company data, UBS

- **PC brands remain resilient despite memory inflation.** The memory price hike cycle has seen resilient sales and margins YTD for the Asian PC brands Asus and Lenovo. The companies have raised prices, prioritized premium mix products, sold through lower cost inventory acquired earlier in the memory upcycle and benefited from some early buying as customers and channels pull forward purchases. Lenovo at UBS Taiwan Summit noted shipments would decline over 10% YoY in CH226 though revenue still up YoY. The company expects operating margins to remain near 6.8-7.0%, implying only modest pressure as it also secures some memory from China source.

Smartphones

We lower our smartphone unit forecasts for '27E and now estimate -3% YoY (was +2%) after -10% in '26E. We forecast +2% YoY in '28E.

Figure 10: UBS smartphone unit forecasts, '25-'27E

Smartphone volume (m)	2025	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26E	4Q26E	2026E	1Q27E	2Q27E	3Q27E	4Q27E	2027E	1Q28E	2Q28E	3Q28E	4Q28E	2028E
Samsung	240	60	65	66	60	250	67	64	66	61	258	67	65	67	62	261
% YoY	7%	-2%	12%	8%	0%	4%	12%	-1%	0%	2%	3%	1%	2%	2%	2%	1%
% of total	19%	20%	23%	24%	20%	22%	24%	24%	25%	21%	23%	24%	24%	25%	20%	23%
Apple	241	60	56	55	90	261	63	59	58	94	273	66	61	60	96	283
% YoY	9%	17%	23%	3%	0%	8%	5%	5%	5%	4%	5%	4%	4%	4%	3%	4%
% of total	19%	20%	20%	20%	30%	23%	23%	22%	22%	32%	25%	24%	22%	22%	32%	25%
Huawei	48	14	16	14	13	56	14	16	14	13	57	14	16	14	14	58
% YoY	0%	3%	24%	27%	12%	16%	4%	3%	0%	0%	2%	0%	0%	0%	8%	2%
% of total	4%	5%	6%	5%	4%	5%	5%	6%	5%	4%	5%	5%	6%	5%	5%	5%
OPPO*	102	31	29	21	18	99	22	22	22	22	88	22	22	22	22	88
% YoY	-3%	31%	20%	-24%	-33%	-3%	-28%	-24%	5%	22%	-11%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
% of total	8%	10%	10%	8%	6%	9%	8%	8%	8%	7%	8%	8%	8%	8%	7%	8%
Vivo	106	21	21	20	21	83	19	19	19	19	76	19	19	19	19	76
% YoY	6%	-7%	-22%	-31%	-22%	-21%	-10%	-10%	-5%	-10%	-9%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
% of total	8%	7%	8%	7%	7%	7%	7%	7%	7%	6%	7%	7%	7%	7%	6%	7%
Xiaomi	165	34	31	29	29	123	29	28	27	27	111	31	30	29	29	119
% YoY	-2%	-19%	-26%	-32%	-24%	-26%	-14%	-10%	-8%	-7%	-10%	7%	7%	7%	10%	8%
% of total	13%	12%	11%	11%	10%	11%	11%	10%	10%	9%	10%	11%	11%	11%	10%	11%
Transsion	96	19	20	18	17	74	19	20	19	18	75	19	21	20	21	81
% YoY	-9%	-10%	-16%	-37%	-25%	-23%	0%	-3%	1%	6%	1%	0%	8%	8%	18%	8%
% of total	7%	6%	7%	6%	5%	6%	7%	7%	6%	6%	6%	6%	7%	7%	6%	7%
Lenovo	55	13	13	13	13	51	12	12	14	13	50	12	12	13	13	51
% YoY	3%	6%	-8%	-8%	-15%	-7%	-10%	-6%	3%	3%	-3%	5%	6%	-2%	0%	2%
% of total	4%	4%	5%	5%	4%	5%	4%	4%	5%	4%	5%	4%	5%	5%	4%	5%
Honor	69	19	14	14	14	61	14	14	14	14	56	14	14	14	14	56
% YoY	8%	12%	-13%	-20%	-24%	-12%	-26%	0%	0%	0%	-8%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
% of total	5%	6%	5%	5%	5%	5%	5%	5%	5%	5%	5%	5%	5%	5%	5%	5%
Other	143	24	12	23	22	80	15	15	16	16	62	13	13	14	14	54
% YoY	8%	-42%	-65%	-39%	-32%	-44%	-38%	26%	-29%	-24%	-22%	-13%	-13%	-13%	-16%	-14%
% of total	11%	8%	4%	8%	7%	7%	5%	6%	6%	6%	6%	5%	5%	5%	5%	5%
Total	1,265	294	276	273	295	1,139	273	268	268	296	1,105	277	274	272	304	1,127
% YoY	3%	-4%	-7%	-15%	-13%	-10%	-7%	-3%	-2%	0%	-3%	1%	2%	2%	3%	2%

Source: Gartner, UBS estimates

Apple

- **iPhone total volumes:** Depending upon the suppliers, build expectations range between c. 240-260mil for '26. **Suppliers are hopeful for growth in '27**. This is in large part due to the expected release of 3 models in 1Q27 (18/18 Max and SE) and 3 in 3Q27 (Pro/Pro Max/Duo).
- **iPhone 18 Pro/Pro Max:** Build volumes appear flat to up 5% YoY vs 17 Pro/Pro Max alone.
- **iPhone Duo:** Volumes are typically expected to reach **10mil units procurement/build in the first 12 months**, at the upward band of prior expectations of 8-10mil. 2H26 build expectations range between 7-10mil depending upon suppliers. Pricing is viewed by suppliers as lower than expected (hence positive for demand).

Samsung

- **3Q26 is tracking in line** with our forecast of 66mil smartphone unit Sell In (+8% YoY, +2% QoQ) with MX division operating losses widening slightly QoQ. Samsung expect steady volumes in '27 (UBSe: 258mil SP units or +3% YoY), as it can leverage captive memory supply.

Xiaomi

- **Xiaomi sold 65mil smartphone units in 1H26, and continues to target 120mil in 2026.** ASPs are expected to be up YoY in '26. As for '27, Xiaomi is uncommitted as to whether it can see YoY unit growth. Assuming memory pricing goes up MSD % QoQ, it expects smartphones GM to remain at 9% and hit that for the FY (note: UBS expects DRAM ASPs to go up more than this). Xiaomi has signed non-binding agreements for memory volume procurements (different from LTAs "stricto sensu") with pricing not fixed. CXMT and YMTC contributes to 15-20% of total memory procurement.

Transsion

- **1H26 smartphone units were down 11% YoY**, with ASPs up 20%. The lower

end was down more than the higher end. Transsion expects to continue to raise pricing to maintain GPM. Regarding '27, Transsion will aim to stabilise unit shipments with some recovery possible in '28. It has reportedly secured memory supply through volume agreement suppliers (although noted as not binding). Transsion already uses local suppliers for >50-60% of total DRAM requirements, and 30% for NAND.

Smartphone Components

- **iPhone supply chain seeing build resilience into 2H26; initial indications up YoY in '27:** Smartphone component suppliers tied to the US smartphone OEM, we believe, are continuing to see build plans for 3Q remain steady with CY26 build expectations ranging between c. 240-260mil units for 2026E with initial assessment for '27 steering towards another YoY growth year (given 6 SKU launches). For overall 2H26, while overall volumes should be down YoY given less available SKUs + some 1H26 pull-in, our supply chain checks indicate that YoY comps for just Pro Series could be trending flat to slightly up YoY.
- **Luxshare:** we believe company is targeting c.40-50% M/S allocation for next year's volumes vs c. 35% in '26E with margins guided to remain steady as non-US customer businesses (PC/Edge Ai Device w/ higher margins) should see gradual YoY ramp into '27.
- **LG Innotek:** we believe Optics revenue are well on course to pick up c.5% QoQ into 3Q supported by stable builds for new refresh, within which LGI should benefit from share gains as well as new Variable Aperture adoption for main wide cam supporting YoY ASP pick up. That said with recent sharp KRW appreciation likely to impact margins, we lower our 3Q26E OP forecast to Won170bn (was Won280bn).
- **Lens Tech:** we see the company as the biggest incremental beneficiary of the new iPhone Duo launch (>US\$120 revenue opportunity per unit w/ front+rear cover glass, UTG, thin film etc.), especially as the main supplier for UTG. Initially, Lens expects iPhone Duo volumes could reach c.10m units just for 4Q26 - usually volumes loaded up front before trailing off.
- **AAC Technology:** we believe the company is seeing their smartphone vapor chamber ASP opportunity picking up to DD US\$ this year for the 18 Pro/Pro Max vs c. US\$5 for last year's iPhone refresh with next year's 1H27 base+Air model refresh also likely to adopt vapor chambers for the first time. With AAC expected to take c. 40-50% M/S within Apple and >50-60% M/S for Android company expects heat dissipation related revenues to grow to c. RMB3.5bn (was initially RMB2.75bn guidance) whilst targeting c. RMB5.0bn revenue in '27.

Foundry

- **Steady Cloud AI demand visibility through end of decade for leading edge.** Given the 3-5 year engagement lead time for advanced nodes with foundry especially for AI/HPC, **TSMC already has good visibility and sees the structural AI/HPC opportunity remain robust by '29-'30.** While there may be uncertainty of short term slowdown, the 5 year trend to '30 is resilient. TSMC has also been taking additional efforts in assessing the industry readiness for new datacenter construction, for example from '26, it has internal analysis to track the power supply build-up especially in the US. These industry analyses along with stronger demand signal from the hyperscalers support TSMC's higher conviction and faster expansion in coming years.
- **Mature foundries to benefit from tighter supply/demand with improving pricing dynamics in '27.** As leading-edge foundries are resource constrained by Cloud AI investment in advanced nodes and advanced packaging, mature foundries are seeing more customer demand flowing through and see industry supply/demand tightening further, which supports higher utilization and more favorable pricing in coming quarters. UMC Q3 utilisation is on track to exceed 90% with confidence to reach 35-40% GM next year through stronger pricing and AI-related mix improvements. Vanguard expects utilization to remain above 90% with continued ASP increases supporting sequential revenue growth into Q4 and '27. Vanguard highlighted utilization as the key driver of pricing power and is targeting double digit pricing increases next year as industry dynamics continue to improve. Hua Hong's Management believe its 100%+ UTR is likely to sustain in the

near future, supported by tight supply of 8 inch and 12-inch mature nodes, rapidly rising AI demand from overseas and domestic customers. Hua Hong management has strong conviction on further pricing increase, with ASP up 10-15% this year and a further increase expected in 2027 as the company believes undersupply will persist. Management estimates that pricing by end of this year will remain 10-15% below the 2022 peak, leaving room for upside

- **New AI opportunities for mature foundry.** On top of the growing power semis from AI servers, Taiwanese mature foundries are trying to capture new opportunities including silicon photonics and advanced packaging. UMC targets to grow AI-related revenue from US\$300mn this year to over US\$1bn by '29. PSMC is positioning itself as a 3D AI foundry supplier for SiCap, interposers, PWF, and WoW, and aims 20% of revenue from AI within three years. As for Hua Hong, it may consider allocating 20-30kwpm 8" equiv. capacity to SiPh over the next 2-3 years.

Fabless ICs

- **Mediatek - Smartphone importance wains with expectations already low, focus on value added projects such as Cloud ASICs:** MediaTek noted that memory will likely remain a factor that affect smartphone sales in '27 with their customers still pretty cautious for smartphone demand in '27 with unit and end cost impacting consumer sentiment, with the company raising prices to pass through elevated manufacturing costs. For '26, MediaTek is still seeing global smartphone units to come down by 15%, of which, Android will drop even more with 20% decline. However, as Apple announced new set of prices for their new lineup, there might be a trend with customers shifting back to Android in H2'26. The company sees its share gains within high end segment to grow, as several customers announced new solutions on flagship SoC and also bringing MTK's products to other parts, such as South East Asia. **MediaTek's main focus now continues to be Google's TPUs. The Google TPU v8t is on track to contribute >US\$2bn sales in Q4'26 and US\$12-16bn sales in '27. For v9 ramping in '28, we believe it is in leading position for more content & share expansion.** As for v10, our view is MediaTek's ASP and overall sales opportunity should continue to rise given greater design complexity, even with Google potentially introducing more ASIC suppliers like GUC / Alchip for compute backend.
- **ASpeed - Server build-out tracking strongly from Aspeed's BMC shipment read-across:** Aspeed is seeing tremendous demand stemming from both general servers and AI servers and of which, agentic AI driven demand appears to have the most robust growth. Aspeed's Q4 guidance implies 60% QoQ sales growth from its Q3 guidance with 67-68% gross margin. The strong growth is a combination of higher unit, AST2700 shipment with higher ASP, and price hike. Current visibility suggests the strength to sustain into '27 with BMC TAM possibly expanding to 60-70mn already based on our estimates (from ~40mn in '26), led by agentic AI general purpose server and GPU & ASIC servers. Tailwinds also include Aspeed's share gain in large ASIC program and potentially more Rubin Ultra units with HBM de-spec.
- **China AI accelerator demand strong, HBM key going forward:** Both Biren and Moore Threads are optimistic about China's AI capex and AI accelerator localization trend in 2026 and beyond. Leveraging with Chinese LLM's MoE and heterogeneous computing architecture, Chinese AI accelerators are playing an increasingly important role in inference (like prefill or decode phase). However, given the rapidly growing demand, **domestic AI accelerator vendors are seeing rising constraint of HBM supply**, which might handicap overall domestic AI accelerator shipment in '26 and '27. Another by-product of tightening HBM supply in China is leading to heightened memory content for GPU card, which might significantly increase total cost of ownership of compute chips for buyers (like CSP or LLM vendor). CXMT is sampling HBM3E for domestic customer testing and qualification, while the visibility on how soon they could start volume production as well as what is the realistic yield remains limited for now. Biren expects **HBM local supply to ramp in 2H'27.**
- **Montage - interconnectivity demand:** Montage's management see agentic AI as key driver to server CPU, which will translate to higher demand of server DRAM module and memory interface chip. For MRDIMM, Montage believe the next generation CPU (incl. AMD and Intel) will trigger end-demand since early '27, as it

could offer much faster transmission speed with limited incremental cost of MRCD/MDR chips (that enables MRDIMM feature). For CXL, the current major application in China remains for better utilizing legacy DDR4 in data center, given rising memory cost.

- **Consumer demand weaker in H226. Fabless IC companies now focus on stronger segments such as networking and auto:** For PC/consumer semis, demand is softening in H226 but remains healthy for Realtek. Sales could hold up better than feared with price hikes to pass through higher supply chain costs. Realtek has started to develop N3 process capability for its future products including smart NIC, retimer, optical controller and AOC cable. The power semis cycle seems to be trending positively, as Silergy is optimistic about its H226 business and Q3 sales should sustain >30% YoY sales growth based on UBSe, with server and auto strength robust and its share gaining consumer business should offset any weaknesses. Overall industry cycle is improving with healthy inventory across the board. Silergy's new SKUs for auto and server are on track to ramp in H226-2027. Silergy's earlier migration to 12" process should drive share expansion especially in '27 when most of its fabless peers are tight with 8" foundry capacity.

IC design services

- **Better H226-2027 outlook on improved support from wafer and OSAT foundries: CPU turnkey project for the top CSP remains the main growth driver in H226F for GUC,** supported by increased wafer allocations for both the CPU project and its other top customers. While the current CPU project carries a relatively lower margin given leading CSP's extensive in-house design efforts, it has also strengthened GUC's customer relationships. This has helped it secure the next-generation dual-die CPU project, which carries higher content and ASP and should see initial revenue from late-'26 with more significant revenue contribution in '27. Beyond the current CPU ramp, GUC sees incremental growth opportunities across ADAS, other CSP CPU/ASIC business, and CPO. Chinese customers' ADAS turnkey revenue is expected to begin in late '26F, followed by a its U.S. 3nm ADAS project in H227F, with both carrying higher margins than the current CPU program. For the other CSP customer, management expects revenue contribution from both CPU and ASIC to begin in H226F and could become another key revenue driver in '27. **Faraday also revised up its H226 revenue** outlook for turnkey business given better support from OSAT makers, as well as more incoming wafer from its customer. Faraday secured over 10 advanced packaging projects in the past 1-2 years, mostly for U.S.-based AI-related projects. It expects advanced packaging revenue kicking in from Q3'26, and views this as the main revenue driver into '27.

OSAT

- **Accelerating advanced packaging expansion.** Industry advanced packaging supply and demand are set to keep accelerating through '27-'28. We forecast industry CoWoS capacity to reach 270kwpw by end-'27, versus 160kwpw by end-'26. We believe TSMC is likely to bring in another OSAT as an additional "wafer-on-substrate" outsourcing partner alongside ASE to meet the sizable capacity needs. While this would introduce some competition for ASE, **we expect ASE's LEAP revenue to grow steadily to above US\$7.5bn in '27E and increase further in '28E,** supported by the faster ramp of full-process CoWoS, ongoing on-substrate packaging collaboration with TSMC, and continued probing outsourcing.
- **Advanced testing gaining importance.** In testing, the move toward chiplet architectures in next-gen AI/HPC designs is set to boost demand for wafer probing and associated test interfaces. As discussed in our [SEMICON takeaways](#), probing is playing a bigger role in weeding out weaker dies ahead of the more complex packaging stages. For test overall, **KYEC expects robust sales growth as increasing AI chip volumes across server CPUs and ASICs expand its testing TAM,** while ongoing cleanroom expansion supports future demand. Despite near term supply chain challenges, beyond this year, the trend toward increasing test intensity, higher power consumption, greater HBM integration and growing wafer-level probing requirements should provide structural tailwind for KYEC's business growth.

Memory Semis

- **Overall AI memory demand:** Regarding recent calls for a possible AI slowdown, memory makers have not seen any changes. If anything, as hyperscalers were not able to have their initial requests met, they have been **asking for upside. This is both for server DDR5 and enterprise SSD.**
- **LTAs:** Negotiations for LTAs with large PC/smartphone OEMs are still ongoing, and expected to be completed by YE.

DRAM

- **Near term pricing:** We now forecast for Samsung blended 3Q26E DRAM ASPs up 27% QoQ and for SK Hynix +23%. **We believe that pricing has re-set higher for mobile DRAM in 3Q** after some discounted contracts in 2Q, whilst mix shift to server DRAM (with higher pricing compared to Mobile) also supporting blended pricing. We forecast 4Q26E DRAM ASPs up 10% QoQ for Samsung, +7% for SK Hynix.
- **HBM pricing:** There has been recent market chatter on SK Hynix discounting HBM pricing for its largest customer. We note that 1/ this customer does receive volume discounts vs others (up to 20%) and; 2/ the contract typically has downward adjustment for yield improvement (the benefits of which are shared with the customer). With different starting points / mix shift effects, we continue to forecast blended HBM ASPs up 62% YoY for SK Hynix in '27E, vs. +93% for Samsung.
- **HBM de-specing, demand:** We reiterate our view that Nvidia Rubin Ultra will initially use HBM4 8-Hi ([link](#)). Memory makers have not received requests for 4-Hi. Even with this, **memory makers have seen a small accretion to HBM bit demand into '27.** HBM de-specing is not happening for ASICs yet but cannot be excluded. Samsung has no intention to change its capacity allocation to HBM.

NAND flash

- **Strong enterprise SSD demand: Memory makers note that enterprise SSD demand has been continuously strengthening**, one vendor mentioning “every week”. This partly relates to higher KV cache offload requirements post HBM de-specing for Rubin Ultra, but is not limited to this. We noted in our last Memory Monthly ([link](#)) that unconstrained bit demand for enterprise SSD (incl Storage) may grow 100% YoY in '27E, vs. constrained closer to 40%, after >90% bit growth in '26E.

China Memory

- **Localisation continues as expected:** Chinese smartphone and PC OEMs have been increasing the % of supply coming from local memory makers. But they also note that pricing is globally aligned. This suggests that memory remains an “open” market globally excluding HBM (which is export-controlled). Hence to us, who supplies what to whom for DDR/NAND does not really matter as it comes to overall supply / demand.
- **HBM:** Considering export controls, Chinese AI accelerator suppliers are seeking localisation. One fabless IC maker expects to onboard local suppliers by 2H27. We note that this matches the expected ramp of CXMT HBM3E. '28 is expected to be more normalised. Til then, HBM is not viewed as a significant bottleneck.
- **Capacity additions: One China equipment supplier mentioned c. 70k wpm capacity addition at CXMT in '26 (UBSe: 62k wpm) and 60k wpm for YMTC (some of that is DRAM; in line with UBSe).** Smaller players may be adding 10-20k wpm (Swaysure, Jinhua etc). **'27 could see total addition of 200k wpm for CXMT+YMTC (UBSe: CXMT 90k wpm and YMTC 60k wpm).** We note this is getting close to operational ceiling (# of process engineers available in particular); we also remind investors of a natural gap between capacity implied by tools shipping vs actual installed (and working) production capacity. The new cleanroom build at YMTC+CXMT (4 fabs in total) could account for 500k wpm theoretical incremental wafer capacity. Regarding process tech nodes, another equipment supplier has seen large preliminary orders for CXMT G4 process (1z nm) not yet G5 (1a nm).

Wafer Fab Equipment

- **Overall WFE visibility:** Japanese tool makers, as do their US peers, have customers providing visibility into 2028. The main gating factor is viewed to be the ability of the equipment makers' supply chains to scale up to meet increasing customers' requirements. **Orders have gotten materially stronger by June**, leading to upward revisions for FY27/3 forecasts. **Initial outlook for FY28/3 appeared particularly robust.** Tokyo Electron reiterated its WFE forecast for US \$150bn in CY26, US\$190bn for CY27, whilst acknowledging possible upside, and expects CY28 to be another growth year. Tokyo Electron has effectively seen upside in all market segments, notably DRAM and China.
- **Tools price increases:** Tokyo Electron is going through like-for-like price increases with major customers. This is key in bringing up gross margins by 5 pct points. Screen is also considering price increases. In Korea, Wonik IPS is reviewing price increases for tools above and beyond reflecting costs increases. This could apply starting '27. TES is considering price increases reflecting inflation in input costs. Eugene Tech is also now reviewing tools price increases. In contrast, Chinese WFE vendors are not considering like-for-like price increases.

Logic WFE

Japanese tool makers have seen a noticeable acceleration in orders in June across the board.

- **TSMC:** Robust WFE orders continue for N3/N2/A16/A14, with one vendor qualifying them as **very strong** with revs possibly up x2 into FY28/3 (also driven by increase in process steps for more advanced nodes and possible share gains). Another vendor characterised TSMC as very aggressive for both N3 and N2.
- **Intel:** Equipment vendors see a **much better WFE outlook vs. the start of the year**. The key driver is, evidently, stronger CPU demand, largely driven by agentic AI. Tools deliveries are expected to materially accelerate in CY27. One tool vendor sees also up x2 revs in FY28/3.
- **Terafab:** Equipment makers have delivered tools for a pilot line. The process tech / process flow is effectively Intel's. Delivery for mass production tools are expected to occur starting '27. There is no evidence so far of memory investment.

Memory WFE

Memory makers are expecting elevated capex levels for the foreseeable future. It is also possible that capex will be up every single year into the rest of the decade, with some flexibility present as always for equipment installation depending upon demand. Yet with LTAs providing some visibility into the next 5 years for volumes, such uptrend is in our view likely. In the near term, Korea equipment makers have seen pull-ins for DRAM end-use tools delivery (Korea, US, China) as well as in some cases NAND (3Q from 4Q26). One important point is that **both Samsung and SK Hynix may intend to execute one phase / clean room every six month for P5-1 and Y1 fabs respectively**. This will contribute to sustained memory WFE for the rest of the decade at least.

- **Samsung:** Equipment will continue to move in into P4 in 2027 to complete the ramp. P5-1 will start to receive equipment in July '27. P5 has a theoretical capacity of 300k wpm, 6 phases. It may do one phase every six months. Whilst the initial focus is DRAM, we could see one phase allocated to NAND flash for 2029 output. P5-2 ground breaking could take place late '27, '28. On the foundry side, Samsung is reviewing Taylor 2 with a decision to go ahead likely in the near term, pending US government approval.
- **SK Hynix:** Equipment will start to move into Y1 in Feb '27. Y1 could also see one phase done every six months. Total theoretical capacity is 360k wpm. M17 (NAND) is targeting output in '29.
- **Micron:** Equipment delivery in F16N (Tuonglo) started already. Equipment delivery into ID1 (Idaho) seems to have been pushed out slightly 4Q26>1Q27.

China WFE

- **Demand: Both Naura and AMEC see strong WFE demand in China in '26 and '27. Of which, memory capacity expansion remains the key driver.** Japanese WFE vendors and Wonik IPS have also experienced upside.

Chinese equipment companies confirmed lengthened lead time from clean room construction (now it is 15 months from prior 12 months) to components/sub-system delivery. This suggest that our forecast of US\$14.0bn/22.5bn WFE spend by CXMT and YTMIC combined in '26E-'27E (roughly represented 110~120k/180-190k wpm capacity addition in the same period assuming average US\$1.2bn for every 10k wpm memory capacity build) are more realistic to be achieved. For leading logic, Chinese equipment companies are expecting 20-30% YoY growth in '26, and further accelerating into '27. For mature node, overall WFE demand is expected to be stable in '26, and get higher in '27.

- **Supply constraint:** Management admit increasing tightness of components/sub-system supply for equipment production. To address this constraint, both Naura and AMEC are planning to diversify the supply chain with higher order allocation to domestic suppliers (given the higher willingness/capability to expand the capacity). Naura believes Q4 will be the tightest season for components/sub-system supply, while it will gradually eased since 1Q27.
- **Localization:** For front-end equipment, domestic substitution remains progressing well in the areas of etch, deposition, cleaning, CMP, etc. For DRAM equipment, Chinese companies expect 40-50% equipment localization to be achieved in '26, compared with 20-30% before.

High NA EUV, DRAM 4F2

- **High NA litho for Logic:** Samsung Foundry will use high NA EUV litho for sub 2nm insertion. TSMC's base case is to not use for A14. Adoption is expected for A10 MP '30 onwards for a few selective layers. An earlier insertion remains possible, but not confirmed, for A14.
- **DRAM 4F2/High NA EUV litho:** For Samsung 0a nm 4F2 remains the base case after 1d nm 6F2. High NA R&D though is taking place right now for DRAM. Whether it would be used for 0a nm 4F2 or not remains in question. A bifurcation to 0a nm 6F2 would make it more likely. For SK Hynix, no final choices has been made between 0a nm 4F2 low NA and 0a nm 6F2 high NA. Our checks though indicates that the 6F2 programme is gaining some momentum.

Back End Equipment

Testing

- **Strong SoC test demand outlook; upside in particular for ASIC/CPU:** Advantest continues to see strong test demand for SoCs, in particular incrementally from June for custom ASICs and CPU demand which resulted in recent revision up in CY26 SoC tester TAM from US\$9.1bn (at mid-point) to US \$11.0bn. While GPUs continue to comprise a bigger share of SoC test TAM, Advantest believes ASIC test demand (seeing strength across the board at multiple customers) vs GPU could see a cross over within the next few years. Advantest continues to see SoC test share at the major GPU customer remaining stable whilst making good progress for share gains for ASIC customers. For CPU, while test intensity vs GPU remains shorter on back end test given mono-die design, Advantest expects test cycle for CPUs to potentially coming up on par to GPUs mid-LT with advanced packaging adoption.
- **Impact of HBM de-spec on SoC test TAM net neutral to slightly positive:** While Advantest believes HBM de-spec for next year's Rubin Ultra to HBM4 8Hi from HBM4E 12Hi will be slight negative for test intensity on like for like basis (die density, pin speed, power etc. correlated with test needs), ultimately better HBM yields from de-spec and in turn higher volumes / SiP shipments should be net neutral to incremental positive for overall test TAM. Going forward, Advantest also believes custom HBM will also introduce another layer of test complexity which should be positive to TAM.
- **Upside to memory test TAM but with potential M/S loss:** Similar to SoC test TAM, Advantest is also noting upside to memory test TAM (both HBM on increasing insertion/test times but also conventional DDR/NAND) but with higher competition in particular for HBM and NAND flash (we believe competition from KR peers DI Corp, YC Corp but also US peers Teradyne). While Advantest as a result expects to see M/S for memory test come off YoY from c.61% in '25, company expects over time to regain some of the lost shares with new memory test tool developments in progress.

- **China expanding test localization efforts into AI accelerators:** Accotest (subsidiary of Beijing Huafeng Test) is engaged with 3 customers on its latest STS8600 testers, having shipped demo tools in Sep targeting AI accelerators. With positive initial feedback from customers for STS8600 (capable of both wafer and final test), Accotest is aiming to securing c. 20% M/S for AI accelerator testers in China near-term and c. 40% M/S by '30 (overlap primarily with Advantest). Based on visibility from customer order guidance, Accotest is set to expand test tool capacity for STS8600 to 100-180 tools/annum next year (Tianjin fab) with plans to further grow production footprint. Though in early stages, Accotest is also eventually looking to enter the HBM test opportunity as well having shipped tools for sampling to key customer.

Advanced Packaging

- **ASMPT continuing to building on logic TCB order momentum:** Having already announced new bulk order of >50 Chip-to-Substrate TCB orders from OSAT customers in July, **ASMPT continues to see order outlook remaining strong on AI related CoWoS capacity expansion into 2027.** With growing visibility on Chip-to-Wafer TCB orders, ASMPT expects more meaningful transition from FC bonders to TCB at TSMC and hence tool POR into '28/'29. In addition, ASMPT sees further upside to logic TCB TAM materializing from 1/ Chip on Panel; evaluation units sent to leading logic customer (CoPoS) with evaluation unit also set for delivery in early '27 for Intel EMIB-T, 2/ CPO; developing TCB and hybrid bonding tools for electronic IC (EIC) on photonic IC (PIC) stacking as well as 3/ potential AI compute TAM shifting to inferencing/CPU supporting higher IC units/tool demand.
- **Likely longer use of TCB tools for HBM; hybrid bonding adoption push-out:** In-line with comments from both Samsung and SK Hynix during the Tech Tour, **ASMPT is seeing use case of TCB tools for HBM being extended potentially to HBM5**, suggesting push out of volume adoption ('insertions' still possible) of hybrid bonding tools. Cost (higher clean room requirements + more back end tools) but also recent decision at key customer to de-spec HBM density (12Hi > 8Hi) may have contributed to push out with adoption. We believe ASMPT may have signed a joint evaluation program with Samsung on development of HBM TCB tools targeting HBM5.

MLCCs

- **Continuing to see visibility on AI server MLCC demand upside:** In-line with our recent SEMCO update ([link](#)), **Murata is also expecting FY27 AI server MLCC revenues to grow 2x YoY followed by another 2x YoY into FY28** with next FY likely to seeing stronger growth contribution from higher end/cutting edge MLCC products (i.e. 1005 size 47uf). Some of the incremental visibility, we believe, maybe coming from LTAs with key CSP customers on 1-2 year forecasts. While Murata expects MLCC content in AI servers, in general, should trend up proportional to die + rack infra thermal design power (TDP), the exact MLCC specs and in turn mix of general purpose (instead opting for higher substrate specs) vs high-end MLCC remains varied.
- **Pulling in timing of MLCC capacity addition:** To address the coming demand, in particular for AI server MLCCs, Murata indicated plans to invest Yen80bn (c. US \$510m) over the course of FY27/28 to grow MLCC capacity by c.30-35% or c.17%/17% YoY in 27FY/28FY respectively, with timeline of capacity pulled in vs c.10%/25% YoY prior. The majority of incremental capacity add, Murata indicated, will likely be set aside for AI server MLCC (c.10-15% YoY increase in FY27/28FY). While Murata maintained that recent EOL announcement for some MLCC SKUs is within 'normal course' of phase off seen every year, there could be incremental changes to M/S strategy potentially with new midterm plan announcement (spanning FY28-30E) set to be announced next year.
- **Growing room for like for like price hikes:** With SEMCO likely set to raise MLCC pricing as early as 4Q26 and into '27, Murata mgmt. indicated seeing the situation around pricing strategy as 'fast changing' - we believe potentially opening up room for like for like price hikes to materialize near-term.

IC Substrates/CCL

- **Favourable pricing environment expected to continue.** Along with

continued spec upgrades for CCL materials, we are also seeing larger chipset sizes and higher layer count driving substrate consumption. Both substrate and CCL makers noted that they believe the undersupply cycles are not looking to peak anytime soon as they continue to see structural demand growth outpacing capacity expansion. **Taiwanese CCL makers are anticipating at least another 15-20% CCL price uplift into H226; while substrate suppliers are looking for blended ABF/BT price to increase high single digits to up to 20% QoQ in Q326 and up another high single digits to low teens QoQ in Q426.** Overall supply chain remains positive on favourable pricing environment that should support gross margin expansion in the coming quarters.

- **EMIB-T yield rate improvement in progress.** Unimicron believes EMIB-T would be a meaningful second-source for selected hyperscaler ASICs considering CoWoS capacity constraints. Yield rate remains challenging given the complexity of substrate manufacturing; but Ibiden is progressing better than peers on the 50% yield rate target asked by Intel while other players such as Unimicron and Shinko are still working through the learning curve. Die bonder provided by JP equipment supplier, Toray, current lead time is around 12 months; and Intel will decide on equipment allocation toward end of '27 based on each vendors yield rate process.

PCB

- **PCB content seeing scale up with transition to RV200:** VGT expects Rubin related PCB revenue contribution and in turn profitability to ramp more meaningfully in to 4Q with Google TPU related main board revenue contribution also expected from 4Q26. In terms of PCB content value, VGT expects per NVL72 RV200 content to grow 2-3x to US\$110k vs GB300 NVL72 of US\$30k. For Google's PCB opportunity (incl. HDI+HLC), VGT expects demand to 2x to RMB40bn in '27 vs RMB20bn in '26 with target to secure at least c. 20% M/S with further scale up as Google TPU v9 looks likely to transition to HDI into '28.
- **Memory PCB and in particular SOCAMM PCB demand showing upside:** Simmtech is seeing incremental upside to SOCAMM PCB demand into 2H26 but also extending into '27 as the company now expects SOCAMM PCB (Module PCB + MCP) to come in at c. Won230bn in '26 followed by tentatively 'at least Won400bn' in '27 (UBSe Won470bn). With module PCB in particular set to reach full UTR into '27, Simmtech recently announced plans to invest Won270bn in capex to bring up SOCAMM module PCB capa by >50% in Cheongju as well as mSAP and RF SiP substrate capacity (from c. Won300bn / annum to Won500bn / annum in revs capa). For module PCB, supported by higher SOCAMM ASP (3-4x higher vs server module), Simmtech expects margins could potentially coming in above prior cycle peak assuming full UTR.

Valuation Method and Risk Statement

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Source: UBS. Rating allocations are as of 30 June 2026.

1:Percentage of companies under coverage globally within the 12-month rating category.

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Company Disclosures

Company Name	Reuters	12-month rating	Price	Price date
AEM Holdings ^{13,28a}	AEM.SI	Buy	S\$9.95	21 Sep 2026
ASE Industrial ^{28a,16b}	3711.TW	Buy	NT\$663.00	21 Sep 2026
Accton Technology Corporation ^{28a}	2345.TW	Buy	NT\$1,840	21 Sep 2026
Advantest ^{28b}	6857.T	Buy	¥32,050	18 Sep 2026
All Ring Tech	6187.TWO	Buy	NT\$1,235	21 Sep 2026
Asustek Computer Inc. ^{28a}	2357.TW	Neutral	NT\$946.00	21 Sep 2026
Compal Electronics ^{1,5,6}	2324.TW	Neutral	NT\$37.60	21 Sep 2026
DI Corporation	003160.KS	Buy	Won35,400	21 Sep 2026
Delta Electronics ^{4,6,28a}	2308.TW	Buy	NT\$1,875	21 Sep 2026
Eugene Technology	084370.KQ	Buy	Won140,400	21 Sep 2026
Global Unichip ^{28a}	3443.TW	Buy	NT\$7,615	21 Sep 2026
Hanmi Semiconductor	042700.KS	Sell	Won236,500	21 Sep 2026
Hansol Chemical	014680.KS	Buy	Won215,500	21 Sep 2026
Hon Hai Precision ^{4,5,6,28a}	2317.TW	Buy	NT\$250.00	21 Sep 2026
Hua Hong Grace Semiconductor ^{16a}	1347.HK	Neutral	HK\$115.50	21 Sep 2026
INNOLUX Corporation ^{1,5,6,28a}	3481.TW	Sell	NT\$50.40	21 Sep 2026
ISU Petasys	007660.KS	Buy	Won110,300	21 Sep 2026
JCET Group	600584.SS	Buy	Rmb72.22	21 Sep 2026
King Yuan Electronics ^{28a}	2449.TW	Buy	NT\$301.50	21 Sep 2026
LG Display ^{16b}	034220.KS	Neutral	Won8,520	21 Sep 2026
LG Electronics ^{8,28a}	066570.KS	Neutral	Won202,500	21 Sep 2026
Largan Precision ^{28a}	3008.TW	Sell	NT\$6,400	21 Sep 2026
Maxscend Microelectronics	300782.SZ	Neutral	Rmb76.34	21 Sep 2026
MediaTek Inc. ^{28a}	2454.TW	Buy	NT\$5,010	21 Sep 2026
Murata Manufacturing ^{28a}	6981.T	Buy	¥7,763	18 Sep 2026
NAURA Technology Group	002371.SZ	Buy	Rmb676.61	21 Sep 2026
Pegatron ^{28a}	4938.TW	Neutral	NT\$90.80	21 Sep 2026
Realtek Semiconductor Corp ^{28a}	2379.TW	Neutral	NT\$740.00	21 Sep 2026
SK Hynix ^{8,28a,16b}	000660.KS	Buy	Won1,868,000	21 Sep 2026
Samsung Electro-Mechanics ^{28a}	009150.KS	Buy	Won1,429,000	21 Sep 2026
Samsung Electronics ^{2,6,8,28a}	005930.KS	Buy	Won274,000	21 Sep 2026
Shenzhen Desay Battery Technology	000049.SZ	Sell	Rmb22.43	21 Sep 2026
Simmtech	222800.KQ	Buy	Won130,700	21 Sep 2026
Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing ^{16b}	2330.TW	Buy	NT\$2,480	21 Sep 2026
Tokyo Electron ^{28a,28b}	8035.T	Buy	¥53,110	18 Sep 2026
Wiiwynn ^{5,6}	6669.TW	Buy	NT\$2,150	21 Sep 2026
Xiaomi ^{28a,16a}	1810.HK	Neutral	HK\$27.58	21 Sep 2026

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon. All prices as of local market close. Ratings in this table are the most current published ratings prior to this report. They may be more recent than the stock pricing date.

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